

The Group Conscience in Preparation for the 2021 General Service Conference



Ed L, Mid-Southern California Area 09

Panel 70 delegate

msca09delegate70@yahoo.com

Cell: (760) 964-0012

<https://www.dropbox.com/s/d0sj2rdq2jjl9j1/2021%20Preconference%20Forum.pptx?dl=0>

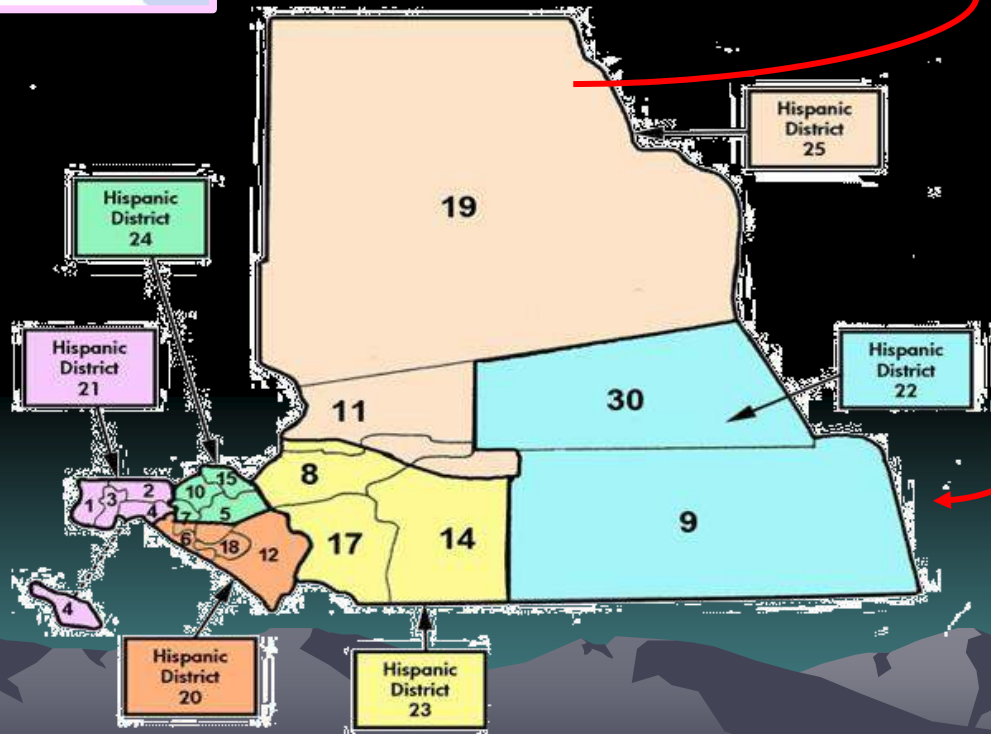


"God gave us bodies
that we
may
embrace
one
another's
souls."

Area 09: Since 1958, 8th Conference



GSR!



62,300 Members

2,003 Groups

24 Districts

6 Hispanic

1 Delegate

???

Communication by Website



Welcome to Area 09



msca09aa.org

Latest Message from our Delegate

Delegate's Sharing Session January 10, 2021

Hindsight's 2020 January 2, 2021

Delegate's Sharing Session December 13, 2020

Register for PRAASA Mar 5-7, 2021

 English

Publicly Available

Mid Southern California Area 09

Home

Delegate

Committees

Districts

Meetings

Events

Contribute

Contacts

Confidential
Information

General Service Office (GSO)

Area 09 Information

Mid Southern California Area 09

of Alcoholics Anonymous®



Confidential Resources

- Report-backs with faces, 1st scheduled for May 4th
- Background Information available on February 15th
- Area items where full names are revealed
- GSO announcements with full names
- Final Conference Reports not anonymity protected
- <https://www.dropbox.com/s/mqzvloivktumsrs/%2370th%20GSC%20Final%20Report%20%28Anonymity%20Protected%29%20-%20English.pdf?dl=0>

13 Conference Committee Assignments in late December

Literature

Panel 70

Sheri P. (25)

Ed L. (09)

Tad J. (48)

Brad F. (78)

Char Van D. (74)

Panel 71

Kunane D. (17)

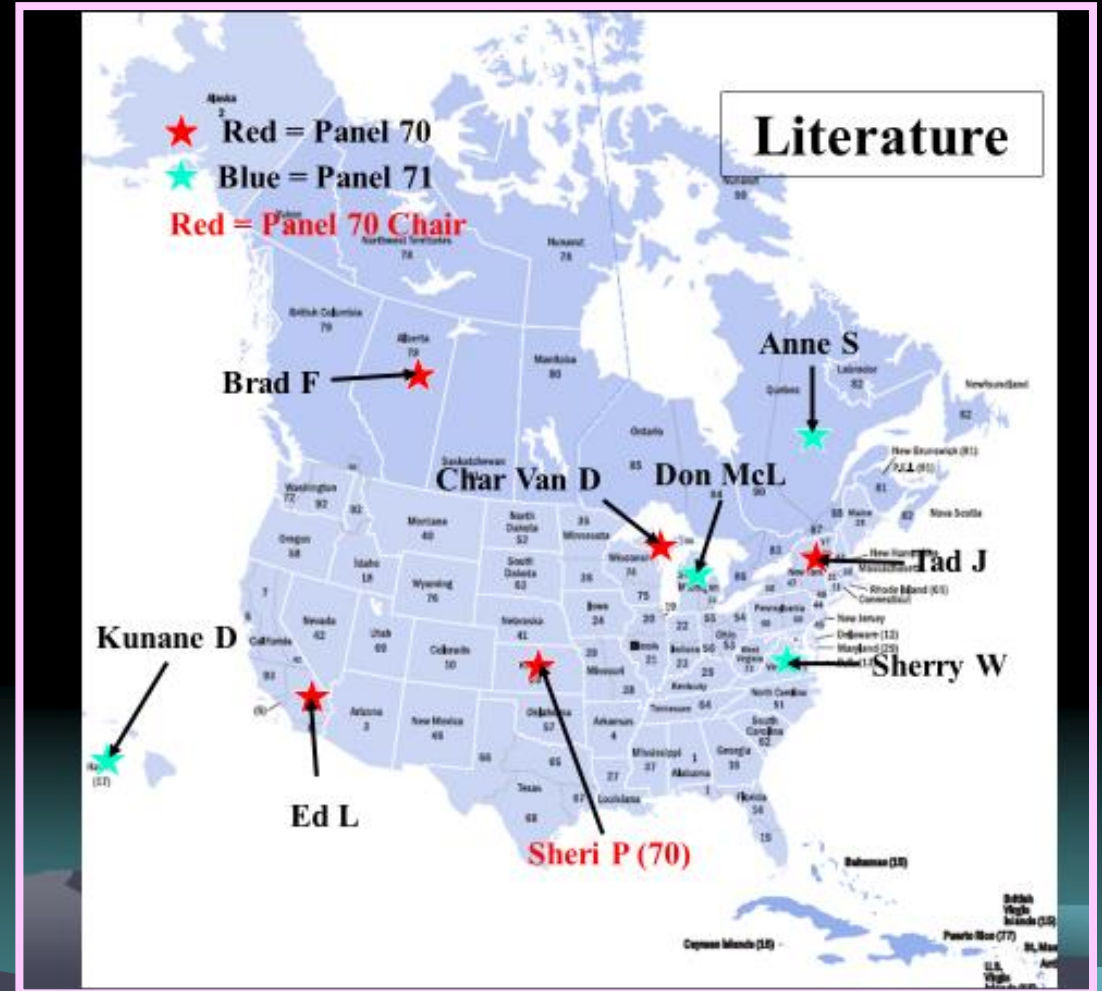
Don McL. (32)

Anne S. (89)

Sherry W. (71)

Secretary = Steve S.

<https://www.dropbox.com/s/geu32erhdt19i1d/Conference%20Committees%2C%20Members%2C%20Chairs%202021.pptx?dl=0>



Pre-Conference Planning and Preparation

- Final Conference Agenda Items on 2/4/2021

VI. Literature

- A. +Review proposed "A.A.W.S. Policy on Conversion of Written Conference-approved Literature and Service Material into Video Format."
- B. +Consider requests to revise the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*:
 - 1. +Add pages 3 through 41 of the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" as an appendix in the next printing
 - 2. +Revise the first 164 pages.

2

+Agenda item forwarded from the 70th G.S.C.

- C. +Consider proposals related to possible Fifth Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*:
 - 1. +Develop a Fifth Edition.
 - 2. +Develop a Fifth Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* with updated stories and revisions to Appendices III and V.
 - 3. +Add a proposed addendum to a Fifth Edition foreword of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* at the time it is published.

<https://www.dropbox.com/s/eye8jolsokfsx1m/%20471st%20GSC%20Final%20List%20of%20Agenda%20Items%20%28English%29.2-4-2021.pdf?dl=0>

Confidential Background Information on February 15, 2021

AGENDA

Conference Literature Committee
Monday, April 20, 2020 – 7:30 a.m. - Noon
Room: Birch
Chairperson: Katy P.
Secretary: Steve S.

Conference Committee Members

Panel 69

Shyrl B.
Matt D.
Katy P.
Serge V.

Panel 70

Brad F.
Tad J.
Ed L.
Sheri P.
Char V.

- K. Consider if proposed agenda items for plain language, simplified language, accessible translations and large print versions of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as well as workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, can be addressed with a common solution.
- L. Consider requests to revise the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*:
 - 1. Add pages 3 through 41 of the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" as an appendix in the next printing.
 - 2. Revise the first 164 pages.



CONFIDENTIAL: 70th General Service Conference Background

Ed

As it pertains to Agenda Item L2

LITERATURE
Item L
Doc. 2.i

District 55 proposal to revise the first 164 pages of the Big Book

Version 4, April 26th, 2019

Proposal:

We recommend that the Conference form a study committee to audit the first 164 pages of the Big Book with the purpose of identifying changes that can be made to make the Big Book more reflective of the A.A. membership composition. The focus should be on identifying the following for possible change:

- Pronoun usage – where possible the gender-neutral form should be incorporated.
- Passages or sections that are no longer consistent with or relevant when taken in context of society in general or the A.A. membership composition.
- The chapters *To Wives and The Family Afterward* should specifically be evaluated for revisions to be more consistent with today's membership.

Once items have been identified these should be prioritized both by the ease of editing and the possible impact to the context of the message. Changes to the overall message should be minimized or avoided entirely. Simplification of the vocabulary should not be considered and references to historical figures and events should remain unchanged.

Background Information

Literature Item B2
in 2021

Personal notes

Highlight text
from 1,100+ pages
in 2020

Informed Group Conscience

- March 20 – 4 Districts host Pre-Conference Boot Camp
- April 11 – Area hosts Pre-Conference Workshop Roundtables (Alt delegate)
- Monthly – Hispanic Interdistrict Business Meetings with all 6 Districts – In Person!



B. Consider requests to revise the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*:

2. Revise the first 164 pages.

Determination: Advisory Action, Additional Committee Consideration, Forwarded (2020)			My vote: Yes or No?		
Responses: English = @; Spanish = @		For: English = @; Spanish = @	Against: English = @; Spanish = @	Pass 	Fail
Group Conscience	Individual Responses	Read Background Material	Read Summary Material		
English = @, Spanish = @	English = @, Spanish = @	English = @, Spanish = @	English = @, Spanish = @		
My Action Items	What do I (personally) need to read?				
Background Information: Background information summarized here					
Conference Thoughts and Results	My notes during the Conference				
Question(s) for Area: Should we revise 164 pages of the Big Book? Why and How? Why Not?					
Area Input: - English: - Area input captured here - Spanish:					
https://www.dropbox.com/s/fd44mwl6ievbhdh/%24Master%20Summary%20Tables%20for%20Agenda%20Items.Final.Without%20Comments.2-4-2021.docx?dl=0					



2020 General Service Conference Committees Agenda Items

VI. LITERATURE

H. Review draft language regarding safety and A.A. to be included in Living Sober and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."

Historical Context: There is a proposal to add wording to the book, Living Sober, to the effect that "it is reasonable for each member to expect a reasonable level of safety." A similar, but connected, proposal is that the pamphlet on sponsorship contain a reference to the service piece "Safety in A.A. – Our Common Welfare" and wording relating to a "safe meeting place," and a "safe environment" within which a culture of sponsorship can flourish at group level. What does the Delegate need to know? What does your group think of the suggested additions? Is the wording helpful? If so, why? If not, why not?

Your answer

Google Forms

2. Revise the first 164 pages.

Historical Context: This proposal comes from a district southwest of Philadelphia, effectively bypassing the approval of the local Area, and seeks to audit the first 164 pages of the Big Book for the purpose of identifying changes that can be made to make the Big Book more reflective of the A.A. membership composition. Driving the proposal is the blunt assessment contained within the Communications Audit commissioned by the General Service Board that A.A. materials present "an overall perception of A.A. as an organization obsessed with its own history and perhaps out of touch with today's population." The proposal further states that the focus of the audit "should be on; identifying Pronoun usage – where possible the gender-neutral form should be incorporated; Passages or sections that are no longer consistent with or relevant when taken in context of society in general or the A.A. membership composition; and, the chapters To Wives and The Family Afterward should specifically be evaluated for revisions to be more consistent with today's membership." Once the audit has taken place, the proposal states that items identified "should be prioritized both by the ease of editing and the possible impact to the context of the message. Changes to the overall message should be minimized or avoided entirely. Simplification of the vocabulary should not be considered and references to historical figures and events should remain unchanged. Where possible, suitable changes should be suggested for incorporation into the text subject to Conference approval." The proposal gives examples of possible edits in keeping with the audit and those that are not. In 1995 the Conference decided that: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, Alcoholics Anonymous, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices remain as is." What does the Delegate need to know? What does your group think about the proposal? Is an audit needed or not? Why?

Your answer

Is the information from a group conscience or individual, and whether they have read the background material and not just the summary

	Group Conscience	Individual Response	Read Background material	read only summary material
VI.L.2. Consider requests to revise the book Alcoholics Anonymous: Revise the first 164 pages.	☐	☐	☐	☐

Google Forms

Current
solicitation on
Plain Language
Big Book (Agenda
Item U)

<https://vimeopro.com/user112910871/big-book-riptab/video/500617913>

Input for every
Agenda Item

Feedback on Video on Creating a Plain Language Big Book

Please provide your feedback on the video, and specifically, on your input about pursuing (or not) the Plain Language Big Book as an Agenda Item at the 2021, 71st Conference of A.A.

* Required

Email address *

Your email

Please share about creating a version of Alcoholics Anonymous that can be read and understood by A.A. members, newcomers, and future A.A.s who live with reading difficulties, including those with a 5th grade-or-less reading level and where English is their second language.

Your answer

Submit Forms to Area 09

Voting for Agenda Item XIII.C. Discuss ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and attract first-time attendees.

Suggested Changes

Your answer



Send me a copy of my responses.

[Back](#)

[Submit](#)

Never submit passwords through Google Forms.

Automatically Uploaded to Excel

AM	AN	AO	AP	AQ	AR	AS	AT	AU	AV	AW
I. "The Twelve Traditions II J. A.A.W.S. Policy: 1. R	2. Review proposed "A.A.	K. Consider if proposed a	L. Consider requests to revise the book Al	2. Revise the first 164 pag	M. Consider proposals re	2. Develop a Fifth Edition	3. Add a proposed adden	N. Consider development	O. Consider	
I don't see any needed changes to this pamphlet.			Pending cost analysis and I believe that this pamphlet stands on its o	Pending cost analysis an	Although I think alternate	Yes	Yes	Definitely a good idea. Pr	Yes. Propos.	
			K2 would be so helpful to	Could be a valuable addition for AA new m	Audit needed	Great idea	The sections listed above and definitely To the W	ive Abs olutely time for a new edition		
						Yes, to reflect current me	To be more inclusive	To be more inclusive		
			This was difficult to gain a	Yes, including it in a future publication of th	Yes, but only on identifyir	Yes - almost 20 years an	Yes to updated stories - no to revisions to appendices			
The group conscience is that such changes in language are unnecessary and			The group conscience is that simplifying the language might take aw		Our group is opposed to	ANY change to the first 16	The group is currently op	The group conscience is that this is unnecessary.		
for			Against	No response		For	For	For	for	for
for			against	against	against	against	against	against		for
				No, the group decided that the new appendix is not needed.					Yes, the groups agreed that it is time f	
Visuals are important			Accessibility is paramount	Not needed	Clarity and inclusion are	Always need to remain re	Committee should decide	Explain changes	Serious errors to be corre	Inclusion is p
				Against. Not necessary. That's what S	Against. If it's not broke	(For. All for a more accur	Against. Updated stories	For. This is a better s	olution to addressing Gender neutral conce	
				my group is not in favor of this	my group is against this	my group thinks this unn	my group does not think i	my group thinks this would be a welcome addition		
Please don't! Making it look modern and up to date goes against the visual in			No. Not needed. "My gr	Yes, it would be helpful and in line with the	No	It's time!	Keeping our book relevant	Keeps in tradition with oti	YES PLEASE SI POR F	Abs olutely -
retire the pamphlet, as it has several offensive images			Many people would like to	get s ober who do not read at an 8th grade	yes, and audit is needed.	Yes, with the original first 184 pages, including Dr Bob's Nightmare		In hearing my Spanish speaking collea		
No preference			This is a very challenging	Good idea	No	Yes. Updates stories can	Yes	Of course	Yes	Always appr
			The group conscience discussed only the summary material. We vot		This is an individual response, related to only reading the summary material. The district did effectively bypass the area approval. which indicate					
			Yes, in an effort to help th	yes, add pages 3-41 of the pamphlet "The	My group feels that the B	My group feels it's time fo	Yes, develop a 5th edition	No, my group feels that each person can get around the biased o		
Do not retire the pamphlet					Audit is a good idea				Yes. The Latino community is a close	

⊕ O. Consider updating the pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic."

Determination: Due to extensive discussion, there was no vote and this item was recommended		My vote: Not applicable	
Committee Recommendation: The committee recommended that the pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic" be updated to include fresh stories and a new title that is respectful and inclusive.			
Responses: English - 24 ; Spanish - 5	For: 4(S) 43(E) = 47	Against: 17(E) = 17	Pass ☒ Fail ☐
Group Consensus (Eng.) 12 (Sp.) 4	Individual Response (Eng.) 27 (Sp.) 2	Read Background Material (Eng.) 11 (Sp.) 1	Read Summary Material (Eng.) 16 (Sp.) 5
• 2019 Conference Advisory Action: The following FLOOR ACTION resulted in an Advisory Action: The proposed floor action that "The pamphlet 'A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic' be updated and a progress report and/or a draft be presented to the 2020 General Service Conference" be committed to the trustees' Literature Committee." • Page 234: The most recent 2014 Membership Survey estimates that only 4% of A.A. members are black, while white membership is estimated at 89%. • Page 236: The pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic" has not been revised since it was originally published in 2001 (except for the title in 2007); CPC, PI, and other pamphlets could be updated to be more inclusive. • Page 241: Table showing blacks in AA, with an all-time low of 10,000 through July 2019 • Page 243 through 245 publish the history of creating the existing pamphlet.			
My pre-Conference thoughts • Yes. Proposal made by Vera, a black woman, so I trust that she understands the needs of her community and support anything that will result in more blacks in AA. • How to find AA on page 36 does not include electronic means and specifically not the Meeting Guide. • Feel personally responsible for having this as one of three recommended items as I felt it was an item to be addressed if there is less time.	Committee reduction thoughts: • The targeted audience was apparently not considered for this pamphlet. So, the CLC has the opportunity to identify the targeted audience. • The distribution number for this pamphlet is lower than some older literature. • Draft was originally proposed in 1991, and by 2007 it achieved today's title of "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic." • CLC member, Sheryl, indicated the current title is condescending (e.g. there is no "AA for the white alcoholic"). The title is also a problem. "People of Color" may be more inclusive than be restricted to members from Africa. She also indicated that new stories need to be put in there. • "Do You Think You're Different?" already addresses different cultures, so this one needs to be available to "blacks" without being off-putting. • Additional Committee Consideration should have the Trustees consider a new title that is inclusive and not condescending. • One Trustee said that the pamphlet really needs to be updated, as a desperate need to welcome persons of color. • Title really needs to be changed. Needs to consider blacks in Canada, not only African-Americans. • One member asked that PSAs may be considered in addition to the updated pamphlet. • What is the expense?		
What does your group think of this pamphlet? Is an update needed or not? Why, or why not?			
Area Input: • English: Yes, update African-American pamphlet - 13: • Written by people of color only. • Absolutely - verbiage is condescending • I support review of revisions, I have much to say about the issue in general and warn caution about addressing "their community", the very concept is divisive.			
No, do not update African-American pamphlet - 5: • I am aghast at the idea of any Alcoholic Anonymous literature specifying a particular race. We are all "one" and there should be NO SUCH PAMPHLET!!! I vote that this be eliminated ASAP. • The message is still in the stories. An unneeded expense • AA shouldn't care about skin color			

Conference
Vote

MSCA 09
Input/Vote

Background
Notes: Before/After

Conference
Notes: Before/After

MSCA 09
Input

In 2020 General Service Colored My Life!

District Business

Area Business

Delegate Report-back

Workshops

Conference Committees

PR Delegates

District/Event	Contact	Date	Time
1	Alex	3/26	7 pm
4	Maryka	4/1	7 pm
12	Romy	4/2	6:30 pm
6	Stacey A	4/7	7 pm
5	Ryan H	4/9	6:45 pm
Archives	Various	4/11	2-4 pm
Traditions in Virtual World		4/11	
TLC	Katy P	4/13	5:30 pm
7	Char M	4/13	6:30 pm
17	Michael	4/14	6 pm
8	Deborah A	4/15	7 pm
Area 09	All officers	4/19	10 am
19	Bob O	4/19	3 pm
GSO	Greg T	4/20	5 pm
PR delegates	Alan	4/22	6 pm
1	Alex	4/23	7 pm
Area 09	1st Zoom	4/26	3 pm
Hispanic 20, 22, 25		4/26	8 am
Hispanic 21		4/29	8 pm
CLC and TLC		5/2	11 am
CLC		5/2	12 am
CLC		5/3	11 am
Area 17	Coleen	5/2	11 am-7
Area 02	Cheri	5/2	10:45 am
Area 06	Teddy	5/2 & 5/3	9-5 & 9-3
PR dels	Alan	5/5	6 pm
10	Laura	5/6	7:30 pm
Conference	GSO	5/7	12-2 pm

District/Event	Contact	Date	Time
15	Albert	5/7	7 pm
18	Rozanne	5/12	6:30 pm
MAY 16 TO 19 PANEL 70 VIRTUAL CONFERENCE			
19	Bob O	5/17	3 pm
14	Lynn Q	5/20	7 pm
9	Ken R	5/24	3:30 pm
Stepping Stones		5/27	3 pm
PR dels	Alan	5/27	6 pm
2 (1st R-B)	Cindy F	5/27	7 pm
1	Alex W	5/28	7 pm
MSCA 09 Board		3/31	10 am
12 R-B	Romy	6/4	7 pm
4	Maryka O	6/6	4 pm
18 R-B	Rozanne	6/9	6:30 pm
21 R-B	Jesus C	6/10	7:30 pm
1&3 R-B	Alex W	6/11	6 pm
19 R-B	Bob O	6/13	10 am
Area 09 R-B		6/14	8:30 am
20 R-B	Rolando	6/15	7:30 pm
22 R-B	Ruben O	6/16	7 pm
PR dels	Alan F	6/17	6 pm
Coachella Intergroup		6/20	7 pm
06 & 08 report-backs		6/20	Various
9 R-B	Ken R	6/21	3 pm
23 R-B	Jose/Dario	6/26	7 pm
4 DCM Share		6/28	9 am
25 R-B	Jose/Jesus	6/29	7 pm
24 R-B	Luis	6/30	7:30 pm



 **Anonymous**